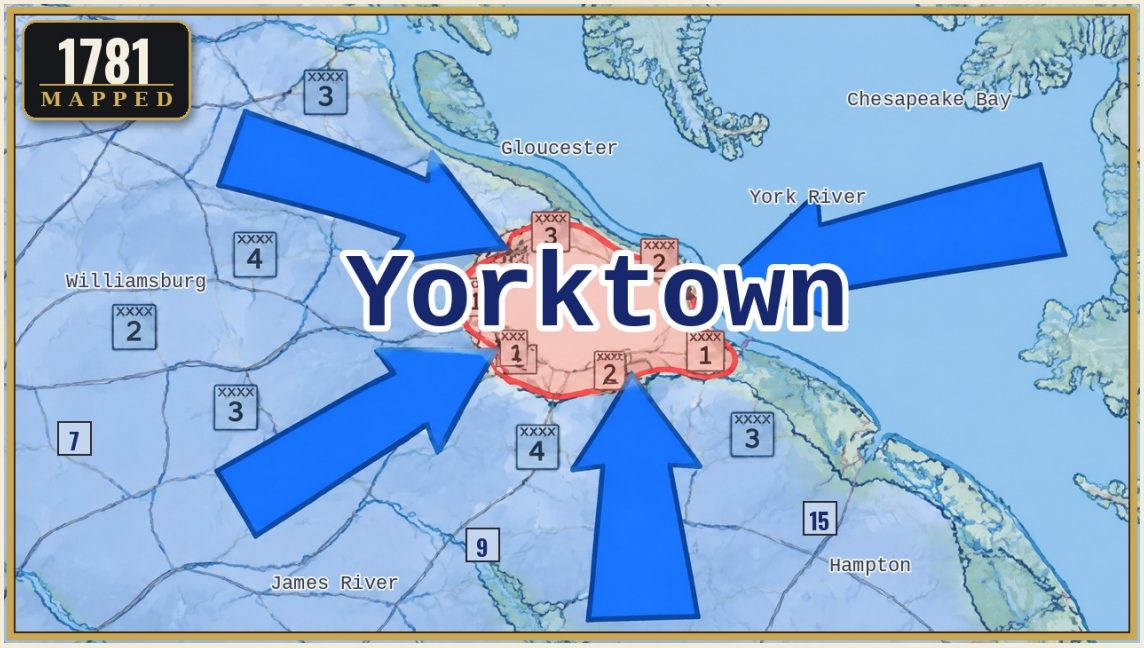
YORKTOWN 1781
THE SAFE HARBOR THAT BECAME A TRAP

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail D2 (owner pick): vidIQ-generated Eastory-style map of the York River, typewriter 'Yorktown', place labels, blue and red side arrows, corner plate '1781 MAPPED' (our own, no channel logo). E and F2 are for Test & compare.

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Yorktown-1781-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC; -14.2 LUFS, true peak -1.4 dB; md5 36ae371524c46487b28676a9d7a3ca65)
Download	https://gofile.io/d/roGkUWAa
Length	16:02
Voice	Owner clone narration (Kokoro text-to-speech converted to the owner's cloned voice; names checked by ear: Rochambeau, de Grasse, Barras, Tarleton, Lauzun, O'Hara)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks (Long Note One, Wounded, Long Note Two, Anguish), CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit (Freesound CC BY 3.0/4.0, CC0, Mixkit); no synthesized ref sounds; artillery only where guns are on screen
Flags	US 13-star flag + French royal white flag with gold fleurs-de-lis (French troops and the fleet) + British Union Flag of 1606 (no St Patrick's cross); Allies (Americans and French) blue, British and their German troops red. One flag per side on the generals' banners.
Look	Main style: Style W ink map + living painted map + map extras (generals as banners on poles, unit boxes with type symbols, painted towns, carved names, rut roads, ferries); coloured front and siege lines; painted side-view ships; rain only on 6-7 Oct and the storm of 16-17 Oct; Netflix archive blocks

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	The Safe Harbor
1:06	Charleston, 1780
1:32	Part 1: Britain's Plan
2:30	De Grasse Is Coming
3:34	The Deception
4:32	Hard Money
5:45	Part 2: The Battle of the Capes
6:58	Two Signals at Once
8:13	Washington Goes Home
8:57	Part 3: The Siege
10:14	A Trench in the Rain
11:42	Redoubts 9 and 10
13:13	The Storm on the River
13:55	The Surrender
15:17	Legacy

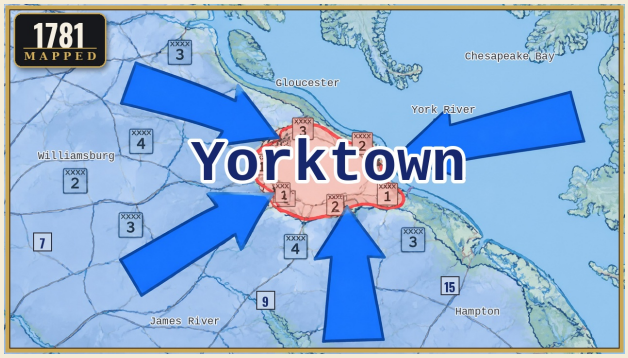
Key frames (first minute: 0:01, 0:06, 0:12, 0:20, 0:32, 0:48)

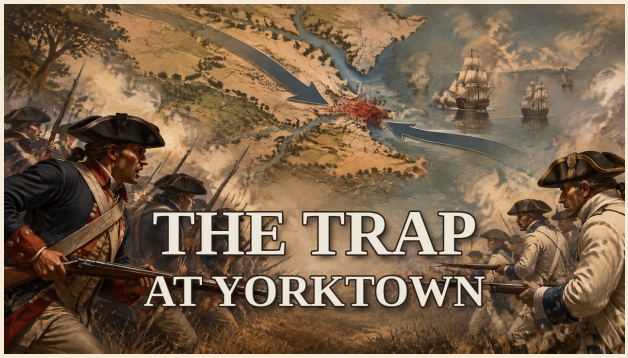


2. Titles and thumbnails (Test & compare)

	Title	vidIQ	Claim check (FACT_NOTES)
A	Britain Thought Yorktown Was a Safe Harbor. Washington Turned It Into a Trap	93	Cornwallis fortified Yorktown as a naval base on Clinton's orders; allied ring + French fleet closed it (Johnston; Stevens)
B	The Battle of Yorktown: How Washington Trapped Cornwallis's Army	91	Famous-battle curiosity title; surrender 19 Oct 1781
C	The Secret March and the Sea Battle That Trapped Cornwallis at Yorktown	93	March south hidden from Clinton (Washington's diary); Battle of the Capes 5 Sep 1781

Main: title A + thumbnail D2. The other titles and thumbnails go into Test & compare. Judge on CTR and impressions on days 1-3, SEPARATELY from retention at 0:30 and 1:00.









Why this text / checked. D2 MAIN 'Yorktown' (Eastory pattern: map + one big place name + arrows; the only map thumbnail in the Yorktown sidebar; fits titles A, B, C). E 'THE TRAP AT YORKTOWN' (Kings and Generals pattern: illustration over a faded map + caps headline; fits A, B). F2 'YORKTOWN 1781 / THE TRAP' (Epic History pattern + arrows; fits A, B). All three made with vidIQ, approved by two independent reviewer agents against the repo's thumbnail study; spelling, labels and stray insignia checked; no channel logo. The rider in F2 is a generic AI officer: never call him Washington. Last picture: the 168x94 feed-size strip.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. NO links (channel rule). Exactly 3 hashtags. Keep the credit lines. Fill in the business email.

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Britain Thought Yorktown Was a Safe Harbor. Washington Turned It Into a Trap
By 1781 the American Revolution was broke, its army unpaid and close to mutiny. At Yorktown, in
three weeks, a safe harbor became a trap.

About eight thousand British soldiers dug in at Yorktown, Virginia, sure the Royal Navy would keep
them safe. This is how Washington and Rochambeau turned it into a trap, told on animated painted
maps: the march south that fooled the British in New York, the Battle of the Capes where de
Grasse's French fleet shut the Chesapeake, and the siege, from the first trench dug in the rain to
the night attack on Redoubts 9 and 10, Cornwallis's failed escape in a storm, and the surrender on
19 October 1781.

Fool the enemy where he is looking. Close the sea. Then close the land.

Which part won Yorktown: the march, the sea, or the siege? Tell us in the comments, and tell us
which battle we should tell next.

CHAPTERS
0:00 The Safe Harbor
1:06 Charleston, 1780
1:32 Part 1: Britain's Plan
2:30 De Grasse Is Coming
3:34 The Deception
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11:42 Redoubts 9 and 10
13:13 The Storm on the River
13:55 The Surrender
15:17 Legacy

SOURCES
Henry P. Johnston, The Yorktown Campaign and the Surrender of Cornwallis, 1781 (1881)
B. F. Stevens (ed.), The Campaign in Virginia 1781: The Clinton-Cornwallis Controversy (1888)
James Thacher, A Military Journal during the American Revolutionary War
The Diaries and Writings of George Washington
Richard M. Ketchum, Victory at Yorktown (2004)
Harold A. Larrabee, Decision at the Chesapeake (1964)
National Park Service, Colonial National Historical Park (Yorktown Battlefield)
Note: "The World Turned Upside Down" at the surrender is a legend first printed in 1828. The war
ended with the Treaty of Paris in 1783.

MAPS
Animated maps made for this channel from open terrain data (Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles, open data)
and USGS National Hydrography data (public domain).

IMAGES
John Trumbull, Surrender of Lord Cornwallis (public domain). Portraits by Charles Willson Peale,
Thomas Gainsborough, John Trumbull, Joshua Reynolds and others (public domain).

MUSIC
"Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish" by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com). Licensed
under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

SOUND EFFECTS
"artillery distance" by 2887679652 (Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0), "Cannon Artillery
distant gunshots" by Aegersum (Creative Commons: By Attribution 3.0), "Distant explosion" by
juskiddink (Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0), via freesound.org.

Business inquiries: [your business email]

#Yorktown #AmericanRevolution #MilitaryHistory
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4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, American Revolution, Revolutionary War, Battle of Yorktown, Siege of Yorktown, Yorktown 1781, Battle of the Capes, Battle of the Chesapeake, George Washington, Cornwallis, Rochambeau, de Grasse, Alexander Hamilton, Redoubt 10, animated battle map, how Washington trapped Cornwallis
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Captions	English; auto-caption, then check names (Cornwallis, Rochambeau, de Grasse, Barras, Graves, Hood, Tarleton, Lauzun, Lafayette, Hamilton, O'Hara, Chesapeake, Gloucester, Lynnhaven)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: AI-cloned narration and AI thumbnails. Tick the box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first at 0:00, all at least 10 s)
Pinned comment	Which part won Yorktown: the secret march, the battle at sea, or the siege? And which battle should we map next?
End screen	From the channel's busiest video to this one, plus subscribe, over the last ~20 s
Schedule	Your audience's peak time; not right after a flop (DATA_RULES)

Upload checklist

- Download from Gofile and play the master once (sound, sync, no black frames); md5 should match.
- Upload the master; paste title A, the description and the tags; upload thumbnail D2 (1280x720).
- Set up Test & compare: titles B, C and thumbnails E, F2.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'; add the end screen; pin the comment; schedule.
- After 24-48 h: log winner, CTR and day 1-3 impressions per traffic source in research/CHANNEL_LOG.md, separate from retention.

Facts to double-check (yorktown/research/FACT_NOTES.md, FACTCHECK_A): troop numbers (about 8,000 British; ~7,000-8,000 surrendered at Yorktown and Gloucester), fleet sizes at the Capes (24 French vs 19 British ships of the line), the two signals Graves flew at once, the storm on the night of 16-17 October, O'Hara surrendering instead of Cornwallis. Not used as fact: 'The World Turned Upside Down' (a legend first printed in 1828, flagged as such).